

Parks Department Meeting May 20th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9SYufiYCSFE
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Muny Park and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, May 20, 2025

Body: Muny Park and Recreation Board

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:23](#) by the presiding officer, who opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chandra Park, James, Mark Irvin, Shannon Powers, and Brad Marshall (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** (None noted in transcript)

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board [00:00:25](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:01:00](#) The minutes from the previous meeting were presented with no amendments or discussion needed. **Approved by Voice Vote.**

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Presentation & Discussion: Indiana-American Water Partnership & Prairie Creek Reservoir

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:01:19 Presentation from Indiana-American Water regarding Prairie Creek Reservoir operations, water quality, and lease/agreement history.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Wade Amos (Director of Operations), Chris Gosell (Water Quality Lead), Jim Henderson (Eastern Indiana Operations Manager), and Joel Rutder (External Affairs Manager).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Wade Amos addressed rumors, clarifying that Indiana-American Water has no intention of shutting down public access to Prairie Creek Reservoir. However, the company aims to balance recreation with its primary function as Muny's drinking water source (supplying 70% of the city's water via 7.4<U+2013>7.5 million gallons per day to roughly 80,000 residents).
 - Amos noted a historical lack of engagement and undocumented "handshake" agreements over the past decade that led to unauthorized expansions, such as the campground growing from 50 planned sites in 1989 to over 230 today.
 - Chris Gosell presented water quality data showing increasing taste and odor trends (geosmin), rising nitrates, total coliform, *E. coli*, and detections of microcystin (cyanotoxins/harmful algal blooms) in 2024<U+2014>with direct spikes following the Fourth of July weekend and heavy water quality impacts in September 2024. While finished water tested negative for toxins, the data raised serious safety concerns.
 - **Path Forward / Policy Shifts:**
 - Indiana-American Water intends to increase collaboration with the city, parks department, and local stakeholders.
 - The company stated its intention to **discontinue ATV usage and horse trails/camping on the west side of the reservoir effective at the end of 2025**, citing environmental degradation and inadequate wastewater holding tanks leaking into the watershed.
 - The company will assess sustainable capacities for boats and campsites and address property encroachments.
 - Board members engaged in extensive questioning regarding property enforcement, historical horsepower limits (noting 20 mph limits codified in state law), and establishing formal written processes rather than verbal agreements moving forward.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation and discussion; no formal board vote taken.
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Superintendent Report & Project Updates

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:09:01 Superintendent Report by Carl Malone.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Tui Pool:** Addressed pre-opening mechanical and valve challenges with assistance from Butter, Bonam & Moore, the Muny Fire Department, Muny Sanitary District, and Indiana-American Water. Parts are arriving to ensure the pool opens for Memorial Day weekend. YMCA water samples are underway, and a new pool vacuum has been delivered.
 - **Splash Pads:** Halman, Riverview, and Tui splash pads are running; Cooley Park and Thomas splash pads require hub replacements awaiting the mechanic's return from vacation.
 - **Westside Park:** JBird LLC is slated to repair the failing main sewer/drain line running from the restrooms. Discussions are underway with Randy O'Connor regarding baseball field and basketball court drainage renovations.
 - **Westside Skate Park:** Anticipated opening in June 2024. Signage and rules are being finalized, and the corresponding ordinance is moving through City Council.
 - **Canal Commons:** Hosted National Parks to the Park Day on Saturday with 75<U+2013>80 attendees despite high winds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and filed.
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Programming & Event Approvals

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:47:56 Summer Programming Report and Event Approvals.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikki (Program Staff) & Board Members.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Nikki reviewed upcoming events, including the Teen Internship Program starting June 4th (partnering with Whitley Community Council for financial literacy, mentoring, and youth job placements), a backpack drive on July 22nd at McCullough Cabin, and a Trunk or Treat on October 18th.
- **Event Actions & Votes:**
 1. **Zion Strong / Everlasting Supporter Inc. (Date & Location Change):** 00:52:12 Request to move event from McCullough Park (June 20<U+2013>22) to Heeken Park (July 11<U+2013>13). **Approved by Voice Vote.**
 2. **Ashley Duke Basketball Skills Camp:** 00:58:28 Request for May 29th at McCullough Park. **Approved Contingent on Security & Insurance Verification by Voice Vote.**
 3. **East Central Neighborhood Association Concert Series:** 00:55:57 Request for small concerts at Washington Park on Wednesdays (June 11, July 9, August 13 from 6:00<U+2013>8:00 p.m.). **Approved for the June 11th event only, with**

subsequent dates contingent on the success of the first event; porta-potty cost coverage applied by Voice Vote.

4. **Oceans Church Event:** [01:02:25](#) Request to use Halman Park on July 12th for a community pickleball and pizza gathering (approx. 100 people). **Approved by Voice Vote** (with a note that church security team names must be relayed to MPD).
5. **Grissom Elementary School Back-to-School Bash:** [00:59:58](#) Request for Cooley Park on July 31st (3:00<U+2013>7:00 p.m., approx. 300 people) with Legacy Life Security. **Approved by Voice Vote** (parks department to provide unlocked restrooms).
6. **Mary's Miles / Recovery Cafe 5K Fundraiser:** [01:07:18](#) Request for Westside Park on August 23rd (6:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m., approx. 200 people, MPD security) with a fee waiver request. **Approved with Fee Waiver by Voice Vote.**

Prairie Creek Report

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:12:15](#) Prairie Creek Reservoir Operations Report.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tony & Kelly.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Beach opens Saturday (11:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. weekends, 11:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. weekdays). Boat launch is open 7 days a week.
 - Security is fully staffed (4:00 p.m. to 4:00 a.m. shifts) and actively enforcing park and fishing rules.
 - Upcoming "Catfish Pirates" event this weekend includes a "Touch a Truck" with fire trucks to benefit veterans.
 - Adding card-payment options for concessions this year. Collaborating with police on Fourth of July and Ironman planning to manage crowds (last year saw 21,000 attendees).
 - Added three loads of sand to the beach and working to remove rocks. Added children's programming (George the mascot, rock painting/snake project).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and filed.

Old Business & Contract Approvals

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [01:19:05](#) Old Business, Committee Reports, and Vendor Contract Approvals.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Internship Program Contract:** Whitley Community Council board approved partnering as a fiscal and educational collaborator. **Approved by Voice Vote** [01:28:08](#).

- **Cardinal Swim Club Contract:** Partnering to provide free swim lessons (baby/me to adult) and Aqua Zumba at Tui Pool. **Approved by Voice Vote 01:28:42.**
 - **Legacy Security Contract:** Tui Pool security services for the summer. **Approved by Voice Vote 01:29:15.**
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:30:13 Jackie Fischer** (Southeast Delaware County resident): Expressed concerns regarding the ongoing maintenance costs of adding new parks (such as the proposed 10th park on Anthony Millwork with Ball State) when current park budgets are tight, and inquired about light reclamation from the Sports Complex.
 - **01:32:28 Danielle** (New reservoir area resident): Voiced strong support for the water company's presentation, urging the board to prioritize drinking water safety and reservoir protections over recreational activities like camping or horse/ATV trails if health risks are present. Inquired about local emergency rescue coverage.
 - **01:37:31 Greg Wilkins** (President, Muny Light Horse Club): Expressed surprise at Indiana-American Water's announcement to eliminate horse trails by the end of 2025. Noted that the trails were officially authorized by the park board on April 17, 1990, under Superintendent Ron Bonham, and that the club has invested over \$12,000 in grants (Ball Foundation, Midwest Equestrian Trail Foundation) to remove invasive species and maintain safe trails over the last 1.5 years. Requested inclusion in future discussions.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Search process for the open Programming Director position is underway with HR (Patty) to review applications and narrow candidates.
 - **Adjournment:** **01:41:20 Approved by Voice Vote.**
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